home in the Government's armoury. Exceptions in the matter of restrictions of liberties rapidly becomes the general rule. Large numbers of books and periodicals are proscribed or prevented entry by a 'Sea Customs Act', and the possession of 'dangerous' literature may lead to a long term of imprisonment. A frank expression of opinion on the political or economic problems of the day, or a favourable report of social and cultural conditions in Russia meets with the strong disapproval of the censor. The *Modern Review* was warned by the Bengal Government because it published an article by Dr. Rabindra Nath Tagore on Russia, an article written after a personal visit to that country. We are informed by the Under-Secretary for India in Parliament that "the article gave a distorted view of the achievements of British rule in India," and hence action was taken against it.[1] The judge of these achievements is the censor, and we may not have a contrary opinion or give expression to it. Objection was also taken by Government to the publication of a brief message from Rabindra Nath Tagore to the Dublin Society of Friends. If a sage like Tagore, interested in cultural matters and deliberately keeping aloof from politics, revered in India and world famous, is suppressed in this way, what of humble folk? Worse even than the actual instances of suppression is the atmosphere of fear they create. It is not possible to have honest journalism under these circumstances, or a proper consideration or teaching of history, economics, politics or current affairs. This is a strange background for the introduction of reforms and responsible government and the like.

Every intelligent person knows that the world is in a state of intellectual turmoil to-day, and that there is a vague or acutely-

[1] November 12, 1934.

[2] On September 4, 1935, an official statement was made in the Legislative Assembly regarding the working of the Press laws in India. It was stated that from 1930 onwards 514 newspapers had been affected by Government demands for securities and by confiscations. Of these, 348 newspapers stopped publication because they could not give further securities; 166 newspapers gave securities amounting to Rs. 252,852.

Recently (in the latter half of 1935) a number of laws suppressing civil liberties have again been enacted for a further long period. The principal one—The Criminal Law Amendment Act—applies to the whole of India. It was thrown out by the Legislative Assembly and later certified by the Governor-General. Many provinces have also passed such laws.